

organisational structures and business processes.

Retail is one of the most active sectors when it comes to DT. JLab is an innovative DT venture by retail giant John Lewis, which offers lots of creativity and entrepreneurial dynamism. It is even encouraging five startups each year and helps them to bring their technologies to market. For example, Digital Bridge, a startup promoted by JLab, has developed a clever e-commerce website that allows shoppers to snap photos of their rooms and see what furniture and other products would look like in their own homes. It automatically detects walls and floors, and creates a photo realistic virtual representation of the customer's room. Here, lighting and decoration can be changed and products can be placed, rotated and repositioned with a realistic perspective.

Companies across the globe are going through digital business transformation as it helps to improve their business processes and leads to new business opportunities. The importance of Big Data in the business world can't be ignored. Nowadays, it is a key factor for success. There is a huge amount of valuable data which companies can use to improve their results and strategies. Today, every important decision can and should be supported by the application of data analytics.

Big Data and open source help DT do more for businesses. DT helps companies become digitally mature and gain a solid presence on the Internet. It helps companies to identify any drawbacks that may exist in their e-commerce system.

Big Data in DT

Data is critical, but it can't be used as a replacement for creativity. In other words, DT is not all about creativity versus data, but it's about creativity enhanced by data.

Companies gather data to analyse and improve the customer experience, and then to create targeted messages emphasising the brand promise. But emotion, story-telling and human connections remain as essential as ever. The DT world today is dominated by Big Data. This is inevitable given the fact that business organisations always want DT based Big Data, so that data is innovative, appealing, useful to attract customers and hence to increase their sales.

Tesla cars today are equipped with sensors and IoT connections to gather a vast amount of data. Improvements based on this data are then fed back into the cars, creating a better driving experience.

DT in India

DT can transform businesses across every vertical in India. Data analytics has changed from being a good-to-have to a must-have technology.

According to a survey by Microsoft in partnership with International Data Corporation (IDC), by 2021, DT will add an estimated US\$ 154 billion to India's GDP and increase the growth rate by 1 per cent annually. Ninety per cent of Indian organisations are in the midst of their DT journey. India is the biggest user and contributor to open source technology. DT has created a new ripple across the whole of India and is one of the major drivers for the growth of open source. The government of India has encouraged the adoption of this new technology in the Digital

India initiative, and this has further encouraged the CEOs of enterprises and other government organisations to make a move towards this technology.

The continuous DT in India is being driven faster with the adoption of emerging technologies like Big Data. That's one of the reasons why organisations today are investing in these technological capabilities. Businesses in India are recognising the challenges of DT and embracing them. Overall, it may be said that the new DT concept is more investor and technology friendly, in tune with the 'Make in India' programme of the present government.

From finding ways to increase business efficiency and trimming costs, to retaining high-value customers, determining new revenue opportunities and preventing fraud, advanced analytics is playing an important role in the DT of Big Data based companies.

The way forward

Access to Big Data has changed the game for small and large businesses alike. Big Data can help businesses to solve almost every problem. DT helps companies to embrace a culture of change and remain competitive in a global environment. Losing weight is a life style change and so is the incorporation of Big Data into business strategies.

Big Data is the currency of tomorrow, and today, it is the fuel running a business. DT can harness it to a greater level. **END** 🐧

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By: Vinayak Ramachandra Adkoli

The author is a B.E. in industrial production. He has been a lecturer in the mechanical engineering department in three different polytechnics, over a period of 10 years. He is also a freelance writer and cartoonist.